



IMAGING: Solomon Lewis

Down with (POP)-Ups

Surf cleaner, and stop wasting precious bandwidth on those pesky pop-ups

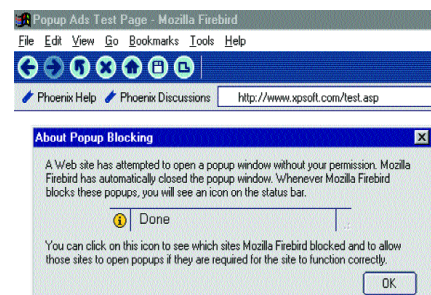
“Free porn in your e-mail”, shrieks the little window. All you did was visit a personality test site, and up popped this tormenting little window. What’s worse, every time you close one, two more appear. Embarrassed, and hoping that no one saw the indecent window, or worse, thought that you were intentionally viewing such material, you close everything and shy away from surfing for a few hours.

The pop-up trend looks set to continue with their continued commercial suc-

cess. These annoying little windows are pushing everything from holidays to software, to the latest online scam into our faces. For those of you who still don’t know what pop-ups are, they are the small windows that open unexpectedly while surfing. This pop-up is not asked for by the user, and can be launched using code within the page we are actually reading. Another variant of this is called the pop-under. Pop-under windows are also launched without any request from the user, but do not come to the foreground; they remain inactive and are seen when the user closes the main window. This is less intrusive but still, quite a nuisance.

Most netizens have learnt to ignore pop-ups—some close the tiny windows as soon as they appear. This works most of the time but with more and more sites adding pop-up and pop-under windows, it would

be easier to have a smart piece of software to do this for you. The reason being that some pop-ups can be quite useful, and the right software will help discern the junk from useful pop-ups. For example, a lot of useful sites like to offer subscription to newsletters or site updates via e-mail. A pop-up, containing a form in which you



Firefox only warns you the first time it blocks pop-up windows

Find them on the Mindware CD

Mozilla Firebird 0.6

PopUpCop

Pop-Up Stopper Professional

Smart Popup Killer

